1. Basic facts

Full name and other names

- **Birth name: Dadabhai Naoroji Dordi (later dropped the surname Dordi)** | Dinyar Patel – Family and Descendants | "the Dordi family (Naoroji eventually dropped the surname) lived in poverty"
-
- **Nickname: "The Grand Old Man of India"** | South Asian Britain | "Other names: The Grand Old Man of India"
-
- **Other nicknames: "The Promise of India" (in college) and "Dadabhai Narrow-Majority" (after his 1892 election win)** | Mint | "Some called him Dadabhai Narrow-Majority"
-

Born and died

- **Born (Version A — Khadak, Bombay): 4 September 1825 in Khadak in Bombay's Native Town** | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "4 September 1825: Dadabhai Naoroji born in Khadak in Bombay's Native Town."
-
- **Born (Version B — Navsari, Gujarat): Wikipedia lists his birthplace as Navsari in Bombay Presidency** | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "4 September 1825 Navsari, Bombay Presidency"
-
- **Died: 30 June 1917 at Palitana House, Cumballa Hill, Bombay, at age 91** | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "30 June 1917: passed away at Palitana House, Cumballa Hill, Bombay."
-

Family, education, work

- **Parents: Only child of Zoroastrian priest Naoroji Palanji Dordi (who died when Dadabhai was four) and Manekbai** | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "His father's sudden death when Naoroji was only 4"
-
- **Marriage and children: Married seven-year-old Gulbai Shroff around 1836 when he was 11 or 12; they had one son (Ardeshir) and two daughters (Shirin and Maki)** | Dinyar Patel – Family and Descendants | "married to Gulbai Shroff, a seven year-old girl"
-
- **Education: Attended a free school run by the Bombay Native Education Society, then studied on scholarship at Elphinstone College (1840–1845)** | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "1 May 1840: enrolled at Elphinstone College. 1845: completed studies"
-
- **Work as educator: First Indian appointed full Professor at Elphinstone College**

(Mathematics and Natural Philosophy, 1854/1855) and Professor of Gujarati at University College London (1856–1865/1866) | South Asian Britain | "he became Professor of Gujarati at University College, London (1856–65)."

- **Work in business and politics: Partner in Cama & Co. (1855–1858), founder of Dadabhai Naoroji & Co. (1859), Diwan of Baroda (1873–1874), and Liberal MP for Central Finsbury (1892–1895)** | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "In 1859, he established his own cotton trading company, Dadabhai Naoroji & Co."

Groups and organisations they belonged to

- **Students' Literary and Scientific Society (founded 1848 in Bombay)** | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "1848: led efforts to found the Students' Literary and Scientific Society."
- **Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha and *Rast Goftar* newspaper (founded 1851)** | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "3 August 1851: joined Navrozji Fardunji in founding the Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha"
- **Bombay Association (founded August 1852)** | Press Information Bureau, Govt of India | "He was an active member of the Bombay Association (1852)"
- **Zoroastrian Trust Funds of Europe (co-founded September 1861 in London)** | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "In 1861, he also founded the Zoroastrian Trust Funds of Europe"
- **London Indian Society (1865) and East India Association (founded December 1866)** | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "1 December 1866: established the East India Association in London."
- **Indian National Congress (Co-founder in 1885; President in 1886, 1893, and 1906)** | The Tribune | "served three separate terms as president of the Indian National Congress"
- **British Liberal Party and House of Commons (MP for Central Finsbury, 1892–1895)** | The Tribune | "in 1892 became the first Indian ever elected to the British House of Commons."

The 5 to 10 most important events in their life (in date order)

1. **1848–1851 — Helped open pioneer girls' schools in Bombay and founded *Rast Goftar*:** Formed the Students' Literary and Scientific Society in 1848, helped set up schools for Hindu and Parsi girls, and started the reformist paper *Rast Goftar* ("The Truth Teller") in 1851. | Press Information Bureau, Govt of India | "In 1851, he founded Rast

Goftar (Truth Teller), a Gujarati fortnightly"

2.
3. **1854–1855 — Became India's first Indian college professor and sailed to England:** Appointed Professor of Mathematics and Natural Philosophy at Elphinstone College before sailing to Britain in June 1855 to help open Cama & Co., the first Indian commercial firm in the UK. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "27 June 1855: departed Bombay and sailed to to Great Britain"
4.
5. **2 May 1867 — Delivered "England's Duties to India" in London:** Presented his first statistical study of the "Drain of Wealth" from India to Britain before the East India Association and called for simultaneous Civil Service examinations in India and Britain. | Press Information Bureau, Govt of India | "Dadabhai read the paper 'England's Duties to India' before a pre-dominantly British audience"
6.
7. **December 1873 – December 1874 — Served as Diwan (Prime Minister) of Baroda:** Worked to reform the courts and administration of Baroda State under Maharaja Malharrao Gaikwad until resigning in December 1874. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "21 December 1874: Naoroji and his ministers tendered their resignations from office."
8.
9. **1876 — Presented *Poverty of India* in Bombay:** Calculated that the average Indian's annual income was only 40 shillings (Rs. 20), less than the cost of feeding and clothing a prisoner in a colonial jail. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "he dropped this figure to an even more precarious 40 shillings"
10.
11. **1885–1886 — Co-founded the Indian National Congress and served as its second President:** Helped launch the Indian National Congress in Bombay in December 1885 and presided over its 1886 Calcutta session. | Encyclopædia Britannica | "Naoroji helped found the Congress Party with Allan Octavian Hume"
12.
13. **1886 & November 1888 — Ran for Parliament in Holborn and was called a "black man" by Prime Minister Lord Salisbury:** Lost his first British parliamentary race in Holborn in July 1886, after which British Prime Minister Lord Salisbury remarked in November 1888 that British voters would not elect a "black man." | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "29 November 1888: Prime Minister Lord Salisbury, in Edinburgh, called Naoroji a “black man.”"
14.
15. **6 July 1892 – 1895 — Elected to the British Parliament for Central Finsbury by 5 votes:** Won Central Finsbury on 6 July 1892 by 3 votes (5 after a recount), swore his parliamentary oath on the Zoroastrian *Khordeh Avesta*, and passed an 1893 House of Commons resolution for simultaneous Civil Service exams. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "He was allowed to take the oath of office in the name of God on his copy of the Khordeh Avesta."

16.
17. **1901 & 1906 — Published *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* and demanded *Swaraj* at the Calcutta Congress:** Published his landmark book in October 1901 and, at age 81, presided over the December 1906 Calcutta Congress, declaring *Swaraj* (self-government) as India's national goal. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "He delivered his presidential address on 26 December, calling for swaraj."
18.

2. Story angles (at least 10)

Angle 1: The Widow's Son Who Promised to Pay Back His Free Schooling (PERSONAL MEMORY by Dadabhai Naoroji)

- **One-line hook:** Raised in a poor Bombay lane by a widowed mother, young Dadabhai decided that because the public had paid for his schooling, he owed his entire life to serving the people.
-
- **Key facts:**
-
    - After his father died when Dadabhai was four, his mother Manekbai sent him to a free public school run by the Bombay Native Education Society. | Dinyar Patel – Family and Descendants | "Manekbai, enrolled the young Dadabhai in a free, publicly-supported school"
    -
    - When Bombay Chief Justice Sir Erskine Perry tried to send the teenage maths prodigy to London in 1845 to study law, conservative Parsi sponsors blocked the trip out of fear he might convert to Christianity. | Mint | "one of his sponsors feared this prodigy might be tempted to become a Christian."
    -
    - Writing in 1904, Naoroji recalled that his free childhood education made him vow to serve the public for the rest of his life. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "'The thought developed that I was educated at the expense of the people'"
    -

Angle 2: The Oil-Lamp Riddle That Opened Four Girls' Schools

- **One-line hook:** When an elder argued that educating girls was like pouring too much oil into a lamp until it went out, young Dadabhai's host used the very same riddle to open four new schools for girls.
-
- **Key facts:**
-
    - Starting in 1848, Naoroji and the Students' Literary and Scientific Society opened

pioneer schools for girls in Bombay in the face of strong community opposition. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "helped establish three girls' schools, personally supervising one"

- When Naoroji asked philanthropist Sir Jamsetjee Jejeebhoy for support, conservative elder Dossabhoy Sorabjee Munshi objected that educating girls would spoil them like pouring too much oil into a lamp. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News | ""you should not supply more oil to a lamp than it can bear""
- Sir Jamsetjee replied that since Naoroji wanted to give girls a balanced measure of knowledge, the lamp comparison actually supported his plan, and promptly funded four girls' schools. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News | "Shortly after, Sir Jamsetji opened four schools for Parsi girls"

Angle 3: The Professor Who Quit His Business Over Morals and Went Broke Helping Friends

- **One-line hook:** After becoming the first Indian college professor, Naoroji sailed to England to help start Britain's first Indian trading company—then walked out on ethical grounds and later went bankrupt bailing out his friends.
- **Key facts:**
  - In 1854, at age 28 or 29, Naoroji became the first Indian appointed as a full professor at Elphinstone College, teaching mathematics and physics. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "1854: appointed as full professor of mathematics and natural philosophy at Elphinstone College"
  - In 1855 he sailed to Britain to help establish Cama & Co. in London and Liverpool, but resigned within three years on ethical grounds and founded his own cotton firm, Dadabhai Naoroji & Co., in 1859. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "Within three years, he had resigned on ethical grounds."
  - When cotton prices crashed after the American Civil War in June 1866, Naoroji's company collapsed partly because he used his money to rescue friends hit by the crash. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "partly due to his eagerness to bail out friends affected by the ensuing cotton bust"

Angle 4: How a Maths Teacher Proved an Indian Lived on Less Than a Prisoner's Food

- **One-line hook:** Using the British government's own tax books, former maths professor

Dadabhai Naoroji proved that the average Indian earned just 40 shillings a year—not even enough to buy the food given to a jail prisoner.

-
- **Key facts:**
-
    - Beginning with his 2 May 1867 London lecture *"England's Duties to India"*, Naoroji calculated that around a quarter of India's tax revenue was drained out of India to Britain every year. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "Around one-fourth of India's revenues, Naoroji asserted, went 'clean out of the country'"
    -
    - In his 1876 study *Poverty of India*, he calculated that total production in India worked out to only 40 shillings (Rs. 20) per person a year, compared to £33 per person in Britain. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "the average income per head in Great Britain was £33."
    -
    - He compared 40 shillings with official Bengal prison records and showed it was barely enough to buy the basic food and clothing given to a convict. | Dadabhai Naoroji: Selected Private Papers (OUP) | "'even for such food and clothing as a criminal obtains there is hardly enough'"
    -

Angle 5: The Poisoned Glass of Crushed Diamonds in Baroda (1874)

- **One-line hook:** As Prime Minister of Baroda trying to stop court bribery, Naoroji was caught between a wayward Maharaja and a hostile British Resident—until someone slipped arsenic and crushed diamonds into the Resident's drink.
-
- **Key facts:**
-
    - In December 1873, Maharaja Malharrao Gaikwad of Baroda appointed Naoroji as his *Diwan* (Prime Minister), while British Resident Colonel Robert Phayre refused to recognise him. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News | "Phayre tried to block Naoroji from entering Baroda"
    -
    - Naoroji demanded an end to *nazarana* (payments to judges) and offered to resign in July and August 1874 whenever palace courtiers blocked his reforms. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "including the abolition of nazarana (payments to judges)"
    -
    - After Resident Phayre survived a poisoning attempt with arsenic and crushed diamonds on 9 November 1874, Naoroji and his ministers resigned in December

1874, just before the British deposed the Maharaja. | Mint | "accused of trying to murder the British resident at court with arsenic and crushed diamonds"

Angle 6: "Dadabhai Narrow-Majority" and the Five-Vote Upset in London (1892)

- **One-line hook:** After Britain's Prime Minister mocked him as a "black man" who could never win an English election, Naoroji won a London seat in Parliament by 3 votes—and a recount raised his win to 5!
-
- **Key facts:**
-
    - After Naoroji lost his first race for Parliament in Holborn in 1886, Conservative Prime Minister Lord Salisbury remarked in Edinburgh in November 1888 that he doubted a British constituency would ever elect a "black man". | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | ""I doubt if we have yet got to the point where a British constituency will elect a black man""
    - Instead of ending his career, the insult made Naoroji famous across Britain; on 6 July 1892, voters in Central Finsbury elected him over Conservative rival Frederick Thomas Penton by 2,959 votes to 2,956—a margin of 3 votes that grew to 5 votes after a recount, earning him the nickname "Dadabhai Narrow-Majority". | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "Naoroji won, polling 2,959 votes to Conservative rival Frederick Thomas Penton's 2,956 votes."
    - Entering the House of Commons as a Zoroastrian (Parsi), he declined to swear on the Christian Bible and took his parliamentary oath holding his own copy of the ancient Zoroastrian scripture, the *Khordeh Avesta*. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "He refused to take the oath on the Bible, as he was Zoroastrian."

Angle 7: Catching the British Cabinet Asleep at Night in Parliament (2 June 1893)

- **One-line hook:** When the British government blocked his bill to hold Civil Service exams in India, MP Dadabhai Naoroji waited until late at night when Cabinet ministers had gone home—and passed a surprise vote by 8 votes!
-
- **Key facts:**
-
    - At the time, the Indian Civil Service exam was held only in London, preventing almost all Indian students from competing unless they could afford the expensive

sea voyage to England. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News | "These exams were only held in Great Britain, a stipulation that barred most Indian candidates"

- After the Secretary of State for India blocked Naoroji's March 1893 bill for simultaneous exams in India and Britain, Naoroji quietly lined up sympathetic MPs behind the scenes. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "1 March 1893: tabled a bill in the House of Commons for simultaneous civil service examinations."
- Late on the night of 2 June 1893, after key government ministers had gone home, ally Herbert Paul called a vote on the resolution and carried it by a majority of 8—handing Prime Minister Gladstone's government its first defeat since the 1892 election. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News | "late in the night of 2 June 1893... the resolution was narrowly carried"

Angle 8: Half a Million People Waiting at Apollo Bunder Pier (3 December 1893)

- **One-line hook:** When MP Dadabhai Naoroji's mail steamer *Siam* docked in Bombay in December 1893, up to 500,000 people packed the streets until his horse carriage overflowed with flower garlands.
- **Key facts:**
  - After Conservative MP Sir George Chesney claimed in London that a Parsi could not represent the people of India, Bombay residents organized a massive welcome when Naoroji sailed home on 3 December 1893. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News (*The Englishman*, 4 Dec 1893) | "to show the English people that Mr. Dadabhai was not, as was observed recently by Sir George Chesney, an alien"
  - Up to 500,000 people—Hindus, Muslims, Parsis, Jews, millhands, and schoolgirls singing welcome songs—lined the streets from Apollo Bunder to Khetwadi until nightfall as garlands filled his carriage. | Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "3 December 1893: arrived in Bombay and greeted by as many as 500,000 people"

Angle 9: Mangoes, Illegible Handwriting, and Guiding Young Gandhi in London

- **One-line hook:** At his London home, Naoroji imported Indian mangoes for homesick students, mentored a shy 19-year-old law student named Mohandas Gandhi, and wrote

thousands of letters in handwriting his friends could barely read.

-
- **Key facts:**
-

    - Living in London for nearly five decades, Naoroji looked after Indian students, helped broke travellers, and occasionally arranged Indian meals or imported mangoes from India to cheer up homesick countrymen. | Dinyar Patel – London and Bombay | "occasionally, he managed to arrange an Indian meal or even import mangoes for his co-nationals"
    -
    - In 1888, 19-year-old law student Mohandas Gandhi arrived in London with a note asking Naoroji for fatherly advice, and in 1894 Gandhi wrote to him from South Africa: "The Indians look up to you as children to the father." | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "Mahatma Gandhi wrote to Naoroji in 1894, saying: "The Indians look up to you as children to the father.""
    -
    - Naoroji left behind 30,000 private documents—including an 1894 eyeglass prescription, plumber's bills, and letters in Gujarati, Marathi, Persian, and French—though one friend complained in a letter that "your handwriting is rather hard to read". | Mint | "as a friend wrote with a hint of annoyance, “your handwriting is rather hard to read”."
    -

Angle 10: What Happened After — The Granddaughters Who Challenged Bandits and Empires

- **One-line hook:** Naoroji's granddaughters Perin and Khurshedben studied in Paris—where one learned bomb-making before joining Gandhi, and the other sang opera before walking alone into bandit camps on the Afghan frontier!
-
- **Key facts:**
-

    - While studying at the Sorbonne in Paris, Naoroji's granddaughter Perin Naoroji was mentored by revolutionary Bhikhaiji Cama and reportedly learned how to assemble a bomb from a Polish revolutionary before returning to India after 1915 to join Mahatma Gandhi's nonviolent movement and promote *khadi*. | Dinyar Patel – Family and Descendants | "As a student in the Sarbonne, Perin Naoroji was influenced by Bhikhaiji Rustomji Cama... A Polish revolutionary apparently taught her how to assemble a bomb."
    -
    - Her younger sister Khurshedben Naoroji trained as a classical opera soprano in Paris, gave up music in the 1920s to join Gandhi, and was arrested in 1930 for

trying to hoist the Indian flag at a government college in Ahmedabad. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "In 1930, Khurshedben was arrested along with other revolutionaries for attempting to hoist the Indian flag"

- In the 1930s, Khurshedben walked unaccompanied through villages and armed bandit (*dacoit*) camps around Bannu in the North-West Frontier Province, persuading kidnappers to release abducted captives and adopt nonviolence. | Dinyar Patel – Family and Descendants | "After several months of walking through the countryside around Bannu and meeting villagers, Khurshed achieved a marked drop in the number of abductions"

Which angle is the big "flagship" story, and why

- **Flagship story: Angle 6 ("'Dadabhai Narrow-Majority' and the Five-Vote Upset in London") paired with Angle 4 ("How a Maths Teacher Proved an Indian Lived on Less Than a Prisoner's Food").**
- **Why:** A 10-year-old reader can immediately grasp the drama of an underdog election where the British Prime Minister insults an Indian candidate as a "black man" who can never win, only for Naoroji to win a London seat by just 3 votes (5 on recount!), take his oath on his own ancient book of prayers, and use his maths skills in Parliament to prove that British rule left the average Indian with less food and clothing than a jail prisoner.

3. People and places connected

People and groups

- **Naoroji Palanji Dordi and Manekbai:** Dadabhai Naoroji's parents; his father died when Dadabhai was four, and his mother Manekbai raised him in Khadak, Bombay, and enrolled him in a free school.
- **Gulbai Shroff Naoroji:** Naoroji's wife (married c. 1836 when he was 11 or 12 and she was 7) and mother of their three children: Ardeshir, Shirin, and Maki.
- **Bal Gangadhar Shastri Jambhekar and Navrozji Fardunji:** Naoroji's teacher and mentor at Elphinstone College in Bombay; Fardunji co-founded the Rahnumae Mazdayasnan Sabha and *Rast Goftar* with him in 1851.
- **Kharshedji Nasarvanji Cama and Sir Jamsetjee Jejeebhoy:** Wealthy Parsi philanthropists in Bombay who funded the pioneer girls' schools promoted by Naoroji and the Students' Literary and Scientific Society.
- **Malharrao Gaikwad and Colonel Robert Phayre:** The Maharaja of Baroda for whom Naoroji served as *Diwan* (Prime Minister) in 1873–1874, and the British Resident who opposed Naoroji and survived an 1874 poisoning attempt.

-
- **Allan Octavian Hume, Sir William Wedderburn, Womesh Chunder Bonnerjee, Dinsha Wacha, and Behramji Malabari:** Co-founders and close colleagues of Naoroji in the Indian National Congress and its British Committee.
-
- **Lord Salisbury (Robert Gascoyne-Cecil) and William Ewart Gladstone:** The Conservative British Prime Minister who called Naoroji a "black man" in 1888, and the Liberal Prime Minister ("Grand Old Man") who defended Naoroji and under whose ministry Naoroji entered Parliament in 1892.
-
- **Mohandas Karamchand Gandhi, Gopal Krishna Gokhale, and Bal Gangadhar Tilak:** Younger Indian nationalist leaders who looked up to Naoroji as a mentor and united behind him as President of the 1906 Calcutta Congress.
-
- **Bhikhaiji Rustomji Cama, Perin Naoroji, and Khurshedben Naoroji:** Revolutionary nationalist Bhikhaiji Cama (who assisted Naoroji in London) and Naoroji's two granddaughters who joined the freedom struggle.
-

Places and events

- **Khadak (Mandvi, Mumbai) and Navsari (Gujarat):** The poor neighbourhood in Bombay where Naoroji was born on 4 September 1825, and the south Gujarat town from which his priestly family originated.
-
- **Elphinstone College, Mumbai:** Where Naoroji studied on scholarship (1840–1845) and became the first Indian full professor in 1854/1855.
-
- **University College London (UCL) and the East India Association, London:** Where Naoroji taught Gujarati (1856–1865/1866) and where he read his 2 May 1867 paper *"England's Duties to India"* on the Drain of Wealth.
-
- **Baroda (Vadodara, Gujarat):** Princely state where Naoroji served as *Diwan* (Prime Minister) from December 1873 to December 1874.
-
- **Holborn and Central Finsbury (London) & Palace of Westminster:** The London constituencies where Naoroji ran for Parliament in 1886 and 1892, winning Central Finsbury by 5 votes to sit in the House of Commons from 1892 to 1895.
-
- **72 Anerley Park, Bromley (London) and "The Sands", Saat Bangla, Versova (Mumbai):** Naoroji's London home (1897–1904/1905, now marked by an English Heritage Blue Plaque) and the seaside bungalow in Versova, Bombay, where he retired in 1907.
-

4. Disputes, legends and doubts

1. Where was Dadabhai Naoroji born? (Khadak in Bombay vs. Navsari in Gujarat)

- **Version A (Khadak, Bombay — backed by Naoroji's own statements and historian Dinyar Patel):** Historian Dinyar Patel, Encyclopædia Britannica, South Asian Britain, *The Tribune*, and PIB all state that Naoroji was born in Khadak in Bombay's Native Town on 4 September 1825 after his parents migrated there from Gujarat, and that Naoroji himself repeatedly clarified during his lifetime that he was born in Khadak, not in the ancestral family house in Navsari. | Dinyar Patel – Family and Descendants | "There remains, to this day, a belief that Naoroji was born in a small house in Navsari that still survives. This is not the case. During his lifetime, Naoroji repeatedly clarified that he was born in Khadak in Bombay"
-
- **Version B (Navsari, Gujarat — popular belief and Wikipedia):** Popular tradition in Gujarat and the main text and infobox of Wikipedia state that he was born in Navsari, Bombay Presidency. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "Naoroji was born in Navsari in a Gujarati-speaking Parsi Zoroastrian family"
-

2. Was Dadabhai Naoroji the very first person of Indian/Asian descent elected to the British Parliament? (1892 vs. David Ochterlony Dyce Sombre in 1841)

- **Version A (First Indian and first Asian MP — 1892):** Most sources (including Encyclopædia Britannica, South Asian Britain, and *The Tribune*) describe Naoroji as the first Indian or first Asian elected to the British House of Commons in July 1892. | Encyclopædia Britannica | "the first Asian to be elected to the British Parliament."
-
- **Version B (Second MP of Asian descent, after Anglo-Indian MP David Ochterlony Dyce Sombre in 1841):** Wikipedia notes that while Naoroji was the first full-blooded British Indian MP in 1892, he was the second person of Asian descent elected to the UK Parliament, after David Ochterlony Dyce Sombre (who had mixed European and Indian ancestry and was elected in 1841). | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "He was the second person of Asian descent to become a British MP following David Ochterlony Dyce Sombre, who was an Anglo Indian MP."
-

3. When did he found the newspaper *Rast Goftar* (1851 vs. 1854) and become full Professor at Elphinstone College (1854 vs. December 1855)?

- **Version A (*Rast Goftar* founded 15 November 1851; full Professor in 1854):** Historian Dinyar Patel, South Asian Britain, and PIB state that Naoroji launched *Rast Goftar* on 15 November 1851 and became full Professor of Mathematics and Natural Philosophy at Elphinstone College in 1854 (before sailing for England on 27 June 1855).

| Dinyar Patel – Timeline | "15 November 1851: published the first edition of Rast Goftar... 1854: appointed as full professor"

- **Version B (*Rast Goftar* in 1854; Professor in December 1855):** Wikipedia states that he founded *Rast Goftar* in 1854 and was appointed Professor at Elphinstone College in December 1855. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "In 1854, he also founded a Gujarati fortnightly publication, the Rast Goftar... In December 1855, he was appointed Professor of Mathematics"

4. Which Maharaja of Baroda appointed Naoroji as Diwan in 1873–1874? (Malharrao Gaikwad vs. Sayajirao Gaekwad III)

- **Version A (Maharaja Malharrao Gaikwad — archival records):** Contemporary 1873–1874 newspaper reports and Dinyar Patel's archival timeline show that Naoroji was appointed *Diwan* in December 1873 by Maharaja Malharrao Gaikwad (who ruled 1870–1875 and was deposed in early 1875), although Naoroji later also maintained close relations with his successor Sayajirao Gaekwad III. | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji's Contemporaries | "Malharrao Gaikwad of Baroda (1831-1882): ruler of Baroda state from 1870 until 1875. He appointed Naoroji as his diwan in 1873"
- **Version B (Sayajirao Gaekwad III — Wikipedia):** Wikipedia's biography section states that he served as *Dewan* to Maharaja Sayajirao Gaekwad III in 1874. | Wikipedia – Dadabhai Naoroji | "His patron was the Maharaja of Baroda, Sayajirao Gaekwad III, and he started his career as Dewan (Minister) to the Maharaja in 1874."

5. By how many votes did Naoroji win Central Finsbury in July 1892? (3 votes vs. 5 votes)

- **Version A (3 votes on election night, increased to 5 votes after a recount):** Both Dinyar Patel's timeline and *Mint* explain why sources give two different numbers: on election night (6 July 1892), Naoroji won by 3 votes (2,959 to 2,956), and when his Conservative opponent demanded a recount, Naoroji's lead increased to 5 votes. | Mint | "When his un-black rival demanded a recount, the tally went up; Naoroji had actually won not by three but by a margin of five votes."

6. Was Naoroji too moderate or too radical in 1906? (Criticism from both sides)

- **Version A (Radical critics like Shyamji Krishnavarma called him too moderate and a "failure"):** In November 1906, radical nationalist Shyamji Krishnavarma attacked 81-year-old Naoroji in *The Indian Sociologist*, claiming his 50 years of constitutional campaigning in England had been a "sad failure". | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News (*Indian Sociologist*, Nov 1906) | "we find that his political work has been a sad failure."

- **Version B (Moderate leaders like Pherozeshah Mehta thought his 1906 *Swaraj* speech went too far toward the radicals, while Tilak hailed it):** When Naoroji demanded *Swaraj* (self-government) at the December 1906 Calcutta Congress, moderate leader Pherozeshah Mehta was unhappy that Naoroji had helped the radical camp, while Bal Gangadhar Tilak's newspaper *Mahratta* praised Naoroji for declaring that "Swaraj is everything". | Dinyar Patel – Naoroji in the News (*Mahratta*, 30 Dec 1906) | "The burden of his song was Swaraj. Self-government occupies the whole address."
-

5. Pictures

1. File:Dadabhai Naoroji 1889.jpg | Woodburytype portrait photograph of Dadabhai Naoroji from Sorabji Jehangir's *Representative Men of India* | Date: 1889 | Licence: Public domain and Creative Commons Public Domain Mark 1.0
2.
3. File:Dadabhai Naoroji.jpg | Portrait of Dadabhai Naoroji from *India, Past and Present* (British Library collection) | Date: 1890 | Licence: Public domain and Creative Commons Public Domain Mark 1.0
4.
5. File:Dadabhai Naoroji, 1892.jpg | Portrait photograph of Dadabhai Naoroji in the year of his election to the British House of Commons | Date: 1892 | Licence: Public domain and Creative Commons Public Domain Mark 1.0
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7. File:Poverty and Un British Rule in India1.jpg | Title page of Dadabhai Naoroji's book *Poverty and Un-British Rule in India* (published in London by Swan Sonnenschein & Co., 1901) | Date: 1901 (1917 on Commons metadata) | Licence: Public domain and Creative Commons Public Domain Mark 1.0
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9. File:Dadabhai Navroji attending the Socialist International Meeting at Amsterdam, 1904.jpg | Dadabhai Naoroji (fourth from right) attending the International Socialist Congress in Amsterdam | Date: 1904 | Licence: Public domain and Creative Commons Public Domain Mark 1.0
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11. File:Mr. Dadabhai Naoroji.jpg | Historical collotype postcard of Dadabhai Naoroji titled *"President, 2nd Congress, Calcutta 1886 and 9th Congress, Lahore, 1893"* | Date: 1905 | Licence: Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International (CC BY 4.0)
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